

their existing Android, iOS, Web, and even old Windows apps and development experience to Windows 10 and to sell such apps on the Windows store.

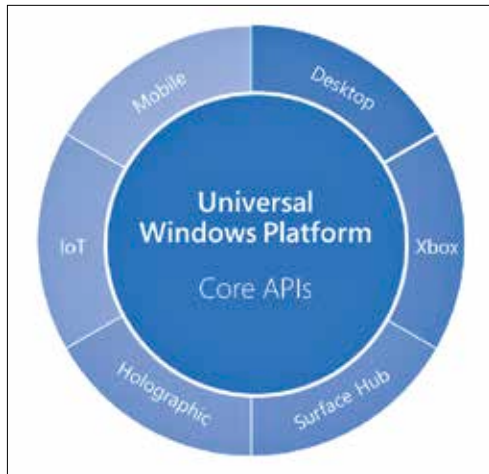
These bridging technologies are: Project Astoria for Android, Project Islandwood for iOS, Project Westminster for web applications, and Project Centennial for 'Classic Windows apps'.

Microsoft has yet to fully explain how these work, however they claim at least for Android that existing applications will need few code changes. For cases where your application uses Google services Microsoft has an interoperability layer that can map those functions to Microsoft's technologies. For instance, it has API mappings for Ads, Analytics, In-app purchases and Notifications. With minimal code changes it can make your code automatically use Bing Maps on Windows while using Google Maps on Android.

These bridges also give developers access to Windows features such as Live tiles while still being able to target competing platforms. In fact, you can even target Windows Phone using your IDE on an OS X system.

Essentially this means Android developers can continue to code in Java, iOS developers can continue to code in Objective-C (they plan to support Swift as well), web developers can continue to code in web technologies and Windows developers used to older technologies can still continue to use them. And they can still have their application running on Windows platforms and sold on the Windows store.

It's already possible to start using their compatibility layer for web applications, which allows you to have websites present as native apps in native windows. Developers can sign up for access to the other compatibility layers while they are still in development.



The new model for Windows APIs tries to as many APIs in common as possible. The only APIs missing should be those that are of no value on other platforms.